CATS INSIGHTS

Delegation & Workflow Framework

Operational Infrastructure Manual

Version 1.0 | February 2026

Prepared by: Kyal Sin Ye Yint (Jason), Founder & President

Executive Summary

This framework codifies the operational infrastructure of CATS Insights. It eliminates decision paralysis, prevents work from disappearing into operational voids, and ensures accountability at every stage of production.

Core Principle: If it isn't documented in the Master Sheet, it doesn't exist.

Metric	Target
Turnitin Similarity Index	< 20% (excluding bibliography)
AI Detection (GPTZero)	< 15% AI probability
Citation Standard	Oxford format with DOI
Meeting Minutes Distribution	Within 24 hours
Bottleneck Alert Threshold	> 7 days in same workflow stage

1. Command Hierarchy

Authority flows from strategic direction to tactical execution. Each tier has defined decision-making boundaries.

Tier	Role	Authority	Reports To
Strategic	President (Jason)	Final sign-off on all publications, strategic priorities, role appointments	Faculty Advisor
	Vice President (Alex)	Captain oversight, task completion verification, President's delegate	President
Operational	Secretaries (Elain, Duc, Aung)	Database management, meeting documentation, bottleneck alerts	President/VP
	Department Captains	Work packet claims, member supervision, standard enforcement	Vice President
Execution	Writers, Editors, Designers	Task execution per handbook standards	Department Captain

1.1 Department Structure

Department	Leadership	Core Functions
Academic Development	Cindy (Head) + Tobb (Deputy)	Training workshops, resource creation, writer mentorship
Editorial & QA	Grisha (Lead Editor) + Daniel (Deputy) + Nana (QA)	Peer review, citation verification, integrity checks
Design & Media	Elain (Lead) + Kateryna (Deputy) + STO (Media)	Visual identity, layout design, social media

Community Outreach	STO (Head)	Charitable initiatives, external partnerships, STEM workshops

2. The 6-Stage Closed Loop System

Every work item must pass through all six stages. Skipping stages or parallel paths are prohibited.

Stage 1: Strategic Brief Creation

Owner	President or Vice President
Action	Define a Work Packet with clear deliverables, success criteria, and deadlines
Output	Written brief in Teams + documented in Master Sheet
Example	"Marketing Team: Create 3 Instagram posts promoting Edition 1, due February 25th"

Stage 2: Tactical Claim & Assignment

Owner	Department Captains
Action	Raise hand to claim packet in leadership meeting. Assign specific member AND Deputy.
Critical Rule	Deputy assignment is MANDATORY. No exceptions. This prevents single points of failure.
Documentation	Secretary logs in Master Sheet: names, roles, deadlines before meeting ends

Stage 3: Execution Using Official Standards

Owner	Assigned Member
Writers	Follow Writer's Guide: word counts, 3rd-person tone, PEEL structure
Designers	Follow Style Guide: color palette, typography, grid system
Editors	Apply Editorial Handbook checklist
Progress Updates	Update Captain at 50% completion AND at submission

Stage 4: Peer Review & Revision

Owner	Editorial Team
Editor 1	Structural review: thesis clarity, logical flow, evidence quality
Editor 2	Line editing: grammar, tone consistency, citation format
Revision Window	3-5 days from consolidated feedback delivery

Stage 5: Quality Assurance (The Gatekeeper)

Owner	QA Lead (Nana)
Turnitin	Similarity index must be < 20% (excluding bibliography)
AI Detection	GPTZero screening to verify authentic student work

Citation Check	All sources verified for accessibility, credibility, Oxford format
Fact-Check	Medical/scientific claims validated against reputable sources
Outcome	"QA Approved" OR returned with specific remediation requirements

Stage 6: Final Approval & RFD Status

Owner	President
Action	Final editorial judgment on content appropriateness and publication readiness
Output	Work marked as RFD (Ready for Design) in Master Sheet
Trigger	Design team begins layout phase immediately

3. The Claim System (Leadership Meetings)

Problem: Work packets historically sat unclaimed because no one wanted responsibility.

Solution: A forcing function that requires claims before meeting adjournment.

3.1 Claim Process

1. President presents Work Packet *(projected on screen)*
2. Captains raise hands to signal interest in claiming
3. If multiple Captains: President assigns based on departmental fit and current workload
4. If no Captain claims: President assigns to most relevant department with explanation
5. Captain names specific member + Deputy **before leaving the meeting**
6. Secretary logs in real-time on projected Master Sheet

FORCING FUNCTION: No one leaves the leadership meeting until ALL new Work Packets are claimed and assigned.

3.2 The 50% Progress Check-In

Problem: Members start strong but lose momentum mid-task.

Solution: Mandatory 10-minute check-in scheduled at assignment time.

Check-In Objective	Action
Progress Validation	Show work-in-progress (outline, draft intro, design mockup)
Blocker Identification	Surface issues early (missing sources, unclear formatting)
Scope Adjustment	Narrow topic if too broad, extend deadline if justified
Deadline Confirmation	Verify on-track status or flag risk immediately

4. The Documentation & Accountability Engine

4.1 Meeting Protocol

PRE-MEETING (1-2 Days Before)

- President + Secretaries draft standing agenda
- Agenda distributed to all attendees **at least 24 hours in advance**
- President announces: 1 week before, 1 day before, same-day

DURING MEETING

Role	Responsibility
Scribe (assigned by Secretary)	Records all information, decisions, and action items
Attendance Taker (Cindy)	Logs attendance using standardized form
President	Leads discussion, takes voice memo backup
Vice President (Alex)	Leads 10-minute Action Item Review before adjournment

POST-MEETING (Within 24 Hours)

- Secretaries finalize and distribute Meeting Minutes to **ENTIRE team** (including absentees)
- Secretaries update Master Timeline: add new tasks, remove completed items
- Secretaries write specific instructions for absent members
- Cindy archives final minutes in Operations Manual (Google Drive)
- President + Secretaries verify all tasks conveyed to department leads

4.2 Master Operations Dashboard (Google Sheets)

RATIONALE: Cloud-based, collaborative, provides historical record. **Local databases, Excel files, and memory-based tracking are BANNED.**

Required Tabs:

Tab	Required Columns
Tab 1: Member Database	Name, Year Group, School Email, Role Classification, Attendance Record, Cumulative Hours, Current Project, Project Status
Tab 2: Article Pipeline	Article Title, Assigned Writer, Assigned Deputy, Workflow Stage, Deadline Date, Submission Date, Editor 1, Editor 2, QA Status
Tab 3: Quality & Integrity Log	Turnitin Index, AI Probability Score, Citation Count, Citation Compliance, Fact-Check Notes
Tab 4: Achievement Tracking	Articles Published, Leadership Hours, Workshop Attendance, Ranking Score

5. Unified Digital Infrastructure

Platform	Purpose	Protocol
Microsoft Teams	Communication Hub - School-approved, integrated accounts, persistent history	Task completed → Post in department channel → Tag Captain → Captain confirms → Secretary updates Sheet
Google Drive	Storage & Collaboration - Central repository for all files	All files in .docx format. Naming: [Topic]_[AuthorName]_DraftX.docx
Google Sheets	Status Tracking - Single Source of Truth	Real-time Captain updates. Daily Secretary scans. Weekly President/VP review.

5.1 Teams Channel Structure

- **General Channel:** All-team announcements, meeting reminders, President updates
- **Department Channels:** Design Team, Writing Team, Editorial Team, Community Outreach
- **Leadership Channel:** Captain-level coordination, strategic discussions

5.2 Google Drive Structure

```
CATS Insights Master Drive/
├── 01_ADMIN/          (Constitution, meeting minutes, member database)
├── 02_OPERATIONS/     (Handbooks, protocols, templates)
├── 03_TRAINING/       (Workshop materials, tutorials)
├── 04_EDITION_1/      (Article drafts, peer review, final versions)
├── 05_MARKETING/      (Social media content, posters, campaigns)
├── 06_OUTREACH/       (Workshop plans, charity documentation)
└── 07_PORTFOLIOS/     (Individual folders for each contributor)
```

6. Performance Standards & Accountability

6.1 Mandatory Attendance Policy

Violation	Consequence
Unexcused absence	Immediate removal from the organization
Late arrival (>10 min)	Counts as half-absence; three half-absences = one full absence
Excused absence	Must notify President/Secretary 24+ hours in advance with valid reason
Makeup protocol	Read Minutes → Complete "What I Missed" form → 15-min catch-up with Secretary

6.2 The Ghosting Penalty System

Definition: A member "ghosts" when they claim a task but fail to: (1) update their Captain on progress, (2) submit by deadline, or (3) respond to Teams messages within 48 hours.

Offense	Consequence
First	Formal warning logged in Member Database; task reassigned to Deputy
Second	Temporary suspension from new assignments; mandatory meeting with President
Third	Removal from leadership role OR dismissal from CATS Insights

6.3 Escalation Timeline

Trigger	Owner	Action
Day 1 Past Deadline	Captain	Direct contact via Teams
Day 3 Past Deadline	Captain	Notify Deputy to assume responsibility; inform Secretary
Day 5 Past Deadline	Vice President	Intervene, reallocate task, document for performance review
Chronic Pattern	President	Reassign roles based on sustained underperformance

7. Bottleneck Alert Protocol

Problem: Upstream delays (writer hasn't submitted) create cascading downstream failures (editor has nothing to review).

Solution: Daily Secretary scans for stalled projects.

7.1 Trigger Conditions

- Project is past deadline with no status update
- Project has been in same workflow stage for >7 days
- Assigned member has no Teams activity logged

7.2 Response Protocol

Step	Owner	Action
1	Secretary	Send Bottleneck Alert to relevant Captain via Teams
2	Captain	Resolve within 24 hours OR escalate to VP
3	Vice President	Resolve within 48 hours OR escalate to President
4	President	Executive decision: reassign, extend deadline, or cancel project

8. Crisis Management Protocols

8.1 When Deadlines Slip

Scenario: 30% of articles still in "Drafting" stage near publication deadline.

7. **Assessment:** President + VP determine if delay is systemic (extend date), isolated (reassign), or quality-driven (publish fewer)
8. **Communication:** President notifies entire team + Faculty Advisor with rationale
9. **Triage:** Rank articles: "Near-complete" (prioritize), "Needs major work" (defer), "Stuck" (cancel)

8.2 When Leadership Fails

Scenario: A Captain isn't fulfilling responsibilities.

10. **Private Intervention:** VP conducts one-on-one to identify root cause
11. **Improvement Plan:** Written plan with specific actions, deadlines, check-ins
12. **If No Improvement:** President demotes Captain, promotes Deputy
13. **If Deputy Inadequate:** President opens applications from general members

8.3 When Quality Standards Are Compromised

Scenario: Article passes QA but faculty later identifies plagiarism.

14. **Immediate Retraction:** Remove from all platforms
15. **Investigation:** QA Lead + President review process failure
16. **Disciplinary Action:** Formal warning (negligence) or dismissal (deliberate misconduct)

17. **Process Improvement:** QA checklist updated to prevent recurrence
18. **Public Accountability:** Brief statement acknowledging error and affirming standards

9. Role-Specific Quick Reference Cards

9.1 Captain's Checklist

WHEN YOU CLAIM A WORK PACKET:

- [ ] Assign a specific member (not "someone will do it")
- [ ] Assign a Deputy for backup
- [ ] Set a deadline with buffer before President's final deadline
- [ ] Communicate via Teams with tagged member
- [ ] Log assignment in Master Sheet
- [ ] Schedule the 50% check-in

WHEN YOUR MEMBER SUBMITS WORK:

- [ ] Verify in correct Google Drive folder
- [ ] Check naming convention: [Topic]_[Author]_DraftX.docx
- [ ] Confirm meets handbook standards (quick scan)
- [ ] Notify next stage (e.g., Lead Editor)
- [ ] Update Master Sheet status
- [ ] Celebrate progress in Teams

9.2 Secretary's Daily Checklist

- [ ] Scan Master Sheet for projects past deadline
- [ ] Scan for projects >7 days in same stage
- [ ] Send Bottleneck Alerts where triggered
- [ ] Update attendance records
- [ ] Post any outstanding meeting minutes

9.3 Member's Task Checklist

- [ ] Confirm deadline and 50% check-in date
- [ ] Review relevant handbook before starting
- [ ] Notify Captain at 50% completion
- [ ] Submit to correct Drive folder with proper naming
- [ ] Post completion message in Teams, tag Captain
- [ ] Respond to Teams messages within 48 hours

10. Appendix: Templates

10.1 Standardized Work Packet Template

Title	[Specific, actionable name]
Objective	[What success looks like in 1-2 sentences]
Deliverables	[Specific output 1, Specific output 2]
Standards to Meet	[Relevant handbook reference, Quality threshold]
Deadline	[Date + Time]
Claiming Captain	[Name]
Assigned Member	[Name]
Assigned Deputy	[Name]
50% Check-In Date	[Date]

10.2 Meeting Agenda Template

CATS Insights [Leadership/All-Team] Meeting

Date: [Date] | **Time:** [Start] - [End] | **Location:** [Room] | **Scribe:** [Name]

Time	Agenda Item
5 min	I. Opening: Attendance check, review previous action items
10 min	II. Strategic Updates: President announcements, timeline status, deadlines
20 min	III. Departmental Reports: Academic Dev, Editorial & QA, Design & Media, Outreach
15 min	IV. New Work Packet Claims: President presents, Captains claim and assign
10 min	V. Problem-Solving: Bottlenecks, process improvement suggestions
10 min	VI. Action Item Review: VP recaps all assigned tasks, confirm clarity
5 min	VII. Closing: Next meeting date, final questions

10.3 RFD Celebration Protocol

Purpose: Create positive reinforcement and momentum when articles reach Ready for Design status.

19. Secretary posts in General Teams: "🎉 [Article Title] by [Author] is RFD! Congratulations to [Author], [Editor 1], [Editor 2], and [QA Lead]."
20. President sends personal thank-you message to author
21. Author's name added to "Published Contributors" board in library
22. Media Coordinator teases article preview on Instagram

11. Implementation Notes

Role	Your Priority
President (Jason)	Schedule 90-min leadership retreat to walk through this document. Run claim simulation exercise.
Vice President (Alex)	During leadership meetings, ask each Captain: "What tasks have you claimed? Who did you assign? Status?"
Secretaries	The Master Sheet is your primary tool. Update daily, run bottleneck checks, flag red flags to President.
Captains	Follow Claim → Assign → Check-In → Update loop to prevent last-minute chaos.

"If it isn't on the Sheet, it doesn't exist. If it doesn't have a Deputy, it will fail."

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